pretend[ing]" that they offered the most effective economic solution to leaders of newly independent countries under pressure to deliver. He argued for aiding these nations that were vulnerable to communist "subversion" or "blandishment," stressing, "it is far less costly to sustain freedom than to recover it when lost."[10]

There were some congressional supporters for aid to India. Senator Hubert Humphrey (D-MN) argued for more aid to India because it was "trying to make its economy work in competition with that Red Chinese outfit." Senator Edward John Thye (R-MN) was concerned that the US would lose India. Representative Marguerite Church (R-IL) did not want to cut aid to India but said that Washington should demand that Delhi be more sensitive to US interests.[11] Others like Senator J. William Fulbright (D-AK), Senator Theodore F. Green (D-RI), and Representative Lawrence H. Smith (R-WI) thought that, overall, the administration was not doing enough in the face of the communist economic offensive and, indeed, was still too focused on military rather than economic aid.[12]

Advocates for aid had their work cut out for them. Some key senators like Styles Bridges (R-NH), Spessard Holland (D-FL), and Charles E. Potter (R-MI) continued to have problems with India's actions that irritated the US, and especially its nonalignment.[13] There also continued to be strong opposition from those like Representative Byrd, who considered Nehru a "menace" and Representative E. Ross Adair (R-IN), who complained about anti-American sentiments in the Indian press. And some American business leaders testified that aid to India was wasted because India was "flirting" with the Chinese.[14]

With some members of Congress still talking about cutting a single-year package to India, the administration put any thoughts of increasing that aid or putting it on a multiyear basis on the back burner. Instead, it was relieved that the single-year aid package for India emerged from Congress only $5 million less than the $70 million request, with an additional $10 million in technical assistance. In August 1956, the two countries also agreed to a three-year $360 million PL-480 package.[15]

Ahead of Nehru's December 1956 visit to the US, the re-examination of American aid policy continued. An interagency assessment linked the "reasonable" success of India's second five-year plan and the health of its democracy.[16] From Delhi, the embassy, led by Cooper, warned of Indian